SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

12 July 2022 · Shift 1

67 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 33 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Have a whale of a time

(A) Be extremely busy with work
(B) A good thing that seems bad at first
(C) Have an exceptionally fun or exciting experience
(D) Immediate involvement of everyone present

Q.2

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. Public agencies and nonprofit conservation groups is already working to promote conservation.

(A) groups is already working
(B) Public agencies and nonprofit conservation
(C) to promote conservation
(D) No error

Q.3

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. The thing about anger is that it can either been a helpful emotion or a discouraging one.

(A) a helpful emotion or a discouraging one
(B) The thing about anger
(C) No error
(D) is that it can either been

Q.4

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person exhibiting excessive worry about one’s health

(A) Intellectual
(B) Hypochondriac
(C) Megalomaniac
(D) Expert

Q.5

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. I “work hardly too” earn bread and butter for my family.

(A) work hardest too
(B) work hard to
(C) No improvement required
(D) works hardly to

Q.6

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. I was at a party / with some off my / friends in Mumbai.

(A) friends in Mumbai
(B) with some off my
(C) No error
(D) I was at a party

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Crocodile tears

(A) Hopeless situation
(B) Totally different
(C) False tears
(D) Of less worth

Q.8

Select the option that corrects the misspelt words in the given sentence. A baloon may liave the earth with a charg.

(A) A balloon may leave the earth with a charge.
(B) A ballon may leave the earth with a chargge.
(C) A balloon may live the earth with a charrge.
(D) A ballun may leave the earth with a charge.

Q.10

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Innability
(B) Inabilty
(C) Inability
(D) Inablity

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Obedient

(A) Compliant
(B) Submissive
(C) Cheery
(D) Resistant

Q.12

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Intricate

(A) Basic
(B) Complicated
(C) Painted
(D) Developed

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. A better plan is "to going and has" a lavish dinner at a fine restaurant.

(A) is to go and have
(B) No substitution required
(C) is to gone and have
(D) was to going and have

Q.14

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who feeds on human flesh

(A) Cannibal
(B) Hedonist
(C) Stoic
(D) Samaritan

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. All branded shoes are priced "extravagantly."

(A) Modestly
(B) Economically
(C) Expensively
(D) Meagerly

Q.16

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. It's _____ too late to start your own business.

(A) never
(B) no
(C) neither
(D) nor

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. It was impossible _____ guess what he was doing.

(A) to
(B) at
(C) on
(D) of

Q.18

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Evident

(A) Obvious
(B) Indistinct
(C) Stubborn
(D) Irritable

Q.19

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who believes in or tries to bring about a state of lawlessness

(A) Ephemeral
(B) Deluge
(C) Gazette
(D) Anarchist

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The sudden death of our uncle was _____ for all of us.

(A) tragic
(B) fragile
(C) gentle
(D) dissuasive

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Nitrogen is essential to life (1)_____ Earth. It is a component of all proteins, and it can be (2)_____ in all living systems. Nitrogen compounds are (3)_____ in organic materials, foods, fertilisers, explosives and poisons. Nitrogen is crucial to life, (4)_____ in excess it can also be (5)_____ to the environment.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) at
(B) into
(C) on
(D) in

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Nitrogen is essential to life (1)_____ Earth. It is a component of all proteins, and it can be (2)_____ in all living systems. Nitrogen compounds are (3)_____ in organic materials, foods, fertilisers, explosives and poisons. Nitrogen is crucial to life, (4)_____ in excess it can also be (5)_____ to the environment.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) founder
(B) find
(C) founded
(D) found

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Nitrogen is essential to life (1)_____ Earth. It is a component of all proteins, and it can be (2)_____ in all living systems. Nitrogen compounds are (3)_____ in organic materials, foods, fertilisers, explosives and poisons. Nitrogen is crucial to life, (4)_____ in excess it can also be (5)_____ to the environment.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) function
(B) instant
(C) immediate
(D) present

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Nitrogen is essential to life (1)_____ Earth. It is a component of all proteins, and it can be (2)_____ in all living systems. Nitrogen compounds are (3)_____ in organic materials, foods, fertilisers, explosives and poisons. Nitrogen is crucial to life, (4)_____ in excess it can also be (5)_____ to the environment.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) such
(B) because
(C) but
(D) if

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Nitrogen is essential to life (1)_____ Earth. It is a component of all proteins, and it can be (2)_____ in all living systems. Nitrogen compounds are (3)_____ in organic materials, foods, fertilisers, explosives and poisons. Nitrogen is crucial to life, (4)_____ in excess it can also be (5)_____ to the environment.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) harmful
(B) pliable
(C) optimistic
(D) rational

General Intelligence and Reasoning 18 questions

Q.1

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) 2 : 6 :: 4 : 60 :: 7 : ?

(A) 600
(B) 105
(C) 201
(D) 336

Q.2

Six girls, Pooja, Qimat, Reeti, Shweta, Tejaswini and Vineeta, are sitting around a circular table. All of them are facing towards the centre of the table (but not necessarily in the same order). Tejaswini is the immediate neighbour of Vineeta and Reeti. Pooja is to the immediate left of Vineeta. Qimat is fourth to the right of Pooja. Shweta is to the immediate left of Pooja.Who is sitting to the immediate left of Shweta?.

(A) Tejaswini
(B) Pooja
(C) Qimat
(D) Reeti

Q.6

Six persons are sitting in two straight rows, facing north. Their names are Farhan, Utkarsh, Yugal, Krishna, Chaman and Manish. Farhan and Manish are sitting at diagonally opposite ends. Utkarsh is in the top row and to the immediate right of Farhan. Krishna is second to the left of Manish while Yugal and Krishna are not in the same row. Who is sitting at the diagonally opposite end to Yugal?

(A) Manish
(B) Krishna
(C) Utkarsh
(D) Chaman

Q.7

After interchanging which two signs will the value of the given expression be '356'? 133 + 49 – 16 ÷ 2 × 34

(A) + and –
(B) – and ÷
(C) × and +
(D) ÷ and ×

Q.8

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. PAN : SCP :: HOP : ?

(A) KQR
(B) KRQ
(C) KSQ
(D) KQS

Q.9

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. ROM, URJ, XUG, AXD, ?

(A) DAA
(B) DAD
(C) DAB
(D) DBA

Q.10

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. TREE : RTEE :: KEEP : EKPE :: SOLO : ?

(A) OOSL
(B) OLSO
(C) OSOL
(D) LOSO

Q.11

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) (3, 6, 18) (5, 7, 35)

(A) (8, 13, 94)
(B) (7, 12, 74)
(C) (8, 12, 86)
(D) (6, 14, 84)

Q.12

In a certain code language, 'Here we go west' is written as '8 6 4 9', 'West and east best' is written as '4 @ # pr' and 'East direction sun' is written as '# jt qm'. Which one of the following is the possible code for 'direction east' in that code language?

(A) @ jt
(B) qm it
(C) 4 qm
(D) # qm

Q.13

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some pets are birds. All birds are mats. Conclusions: I. All mats are birds. II. Some mats are pets.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(D) Only conclusion I follows.

Q.17

In a certain code language, 'IFSP' is written as 'JHTR' and 'MPWF' is written as 'NRXH'. How will 'TOAD' be written in that language?

(A) UQCE
(B) UQBF
(C) UQCF
(D) UPBF

Q.18

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: No plate is a spoon. Some plates are forks. All forks are knives. Conclusions: I. Some plates are knives is a possibility. II. No spoon is a fork.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.19

D 2 is related to H 6 in a certain way. In the same way, L 11 is related to P 15. To which of the following is T 18 related following the same logic?

(A) Z 22
(B) X 22
(C) Y 22
(D) W 22

Q.20

Which two signs need to be interchanged to make the following equation correct? $9 + 3 - 4 \div 5 \times 2 = 9$

(A) – and ×
(B) + and x
(C) + and ÷
(D) – and +

Q.21

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 728, 717, 695, 662, 618, ?

(A) 564
(B) 561
(C) 563
(D) 562

Q.22

In a certain code language, 'ANAEMIA' is written as 'AOAENIA', 'AQUEOUS' is written as 'ARUEOUT', and 'LIVELY' is written as 'MIWEMZ'. How will 'EUGENIA' be written in that language?

(A) EUHEOJA
(B) FVGFNJB
(C) EUHEOIA
(D) FUGFNJB

Q.23

In a certain code language, ‘POR’ is coded as ‘52’ and ‘AND’ is coded as ‘22’. How will ‘VXB’ be coded in that language?

(A) 51
(B) 49
(C) 48
(D) 52

Q.24

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) 12 : 20 :: 8 : 12 :: 34 : ?

(A) 52
(B) 64
(C) 48
(D) 56

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Tanjore Balasaraswati was known for which classical dance form?

(A) Bihu
(B) Bharatanatyam
(C) Manipuri
(D) Odissi

Q.2

Which of the following persons won the 'Best Female Debut' Award at the 2021 Paralympic Sports Awards 2021?

(A) Deepa Malik
(B) Bhavinaben Patel
(C) Avani Lekhara
(D) Mirabai Chanu

Q.3

Which of the following rivers forms the largest river system of Rajasthan?

(A) Krishna
(B) Narmada
(C) Tapi
(D) Luni

Q.4

In human beings, the small intestine is coiled and is about _____ metres long.

(A) 1 to 1.5
(B) 3 to 3.5
(C) 2 to 2.5
(D) 7 to 7.5

Q.5

Who among the following was the first athlete to represent India in fencing at the Tokyo Olympics 2020?

(A) Aditi Ashok
(B) PT Usha
(C) Bhavani Devi
(D) PV Sindhu

Q.6

A form of financial service which provides small loans and other financial services to poor and low-income households is called _____.

(A) microfinance
(B) commercial mortgage
(C) invoice financing
(D) personal finance

Q.7

Which of the following are also called the amphibians of the plant kingdom?

(A) Pteridophytes
(B) Thallophytes
(C) Angiosperms
(D) Bryophytes

Q.8

Buddha attained enlightenment at _____.

(A) Varanasi
(B) Bodh Gaya
(C) Kusinara
(D) Pataliputra

Q.9

'Unfinished: A Memoir' is the autobiography of _____.

(A) Priyanka Chopra Jonas
(B) Deepika Padukone
(C) Kareena Kapoor
(D) Alia Bhatt

Q.10

Which of the following festivals is celebrated when the annual harvest takes place in Assam?

(A) Lohri
(B) Pongal
(C) Magh Bihu
(D) Makaravilakku

Q.11

Which of the following is considered to be the fifth state of matter?

(A) Bose-Einstein condensate
(B) Plasma
(C) Solid
(D) Gas

Q.12

Which of the following peninsular rivers has the largest drainage basin?

(A) Godavari
(B) Mahanadi
(C) Narmada
(D) Krishna

Q.13

A type of unemployment in rural areas when people are not able to find jobs during some months of the year is called _____.

(A) educated unemployment
(B) disguised unemployment
(C) frictional unemployment
(D) seasonal unemployment

Q.14

Vasco da Gama, a Portuguese explorer came to India in _____.

(A) 1496
(B) 1498
(C) 1495
(D) 1497

Q.15

Who among the following addressed the Indian National congress as its President in 1887?

(A) Balgangadhar Tilak
(B) Badruddin Tyabji
(C) WC Bannerji
(D) Dadabhai Naoroji

Q.16

Which team lost to Dabang Delhi KC in the finals of the Pro Kabbadi League season 8?

(A) Puneri Paltan
(B) Patna Pirates
(C) Gujarat Giants
(D) UP Yoddha

Q.17

Soilless agriculture is called _____.

(A) hydroponics
(B) shifting agriculture
(C) dry farming
(D) pastoral farming

Q.18

Which Article of the Indian Constitution enshrines the Right against Exploitation?

(A) Article 23
(B) Article 21
(C) Article 25
(D) Article 22

Q.19
What does ‘Chaitya’ in Buddhist architecture refer to?

(A) Buddha relic
(B) Prayer hall
(C) Residence
(D) Monastery

Q.20
As per Census 2011, what is the Total Fertility Rate (an approximate range) in India?

(A) 3.1 - 3.9
(B) 2.1 - 2.9
(C) 5.1 - 5.9
(D) 4.1 - 4.9

Q.21
Who among the following is a famous Sitar player?

(A) Ustad Rehman Khan
(B) Kishan Maharaj
(C) Ali Ahmad Hussain
(D) Anoushka Shankar

Q.22
As per the Constitution of India, the President of India shall hold office for a term of _____ from the date on which he enters upon his office.

(A) four years
(B) six years
(C) three years
(D) five years

Q.23
Mohiniyattam is a classical dance form of which Indian state?

(A) Andhra Pradesh
(B) Kerala
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Assam

Q.24
Which Chola ruler built the Brihadeshwara Temple at Tanjore?

(A) Rajaraja I
(B) Rajendra I
(C) Vijayalaya
(D) Rajendra III

Q.25
Which state of India has set up District Investment Promotion Agencies (DIPA)?

(A) Karnataka
(B) Haryana
(C) Odisha
(D) West Bengal

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(A)**

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**
Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (C) Have an exceptionally fun or exciting experience

To 'have a whale of a time' is to enjoy oneself very much.

Q.2 · Answer (A) groups is already working

The subject, 'public agencies and nonprofit conservation groups', is plural, so the verb must be 'are': 'groups are already working'.

Q.3 · Answer (D) is that it can either been

After the modal 'can' a verb takes its base form: 'it can either be a helpful emotion or a discouraging one'.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Hypochondriac

A hypochondriac worries too much about his or her health, imagining illness. A megalomaniac is obsessed with his own power.

Q.5 · Answer (B) work hard to

'Hard' is the adverb for working with effort ('hardly' means scarcely), and purpose is shown by 'to', not 'too': 'I work hard to earn bread and butter for my family.'

Q.6 · Answer (B) with some off my

The preposition is 'of', not 'off': 'with some of my friends in Mumbai'.

Q.7 · Answer (C) False tears

'Crocodile tears' are false tears, a show of sorrow that is not really felt.

Q.8 · Answer (A) A balloon may leave the earth with a charge.

The correct spellings are 'balloon' (double 'l', double 'o'), 'leave' and 'charge'.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Inability

The correct spelling is 'inability': 'in-' with 'ability'.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Resistant

'Obedient' means willing to obey; 'resistant', refusing to go along, is its opposite. 'Compliant' and 'submissive' are synonyms.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Complicated

'Intricate' means having many connected parts or details, that is 'complicated'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) is to go and have

'To' takes the base form of the verb, and 'have' must match 'go': 'A better plan is to go and have a lavish dinner at a fine restaurant.' The options repeat the 'is' printed just before the underlined words.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Cannibal

A cannibal eats human flesh. A hedonist lives for pleasure, a stoic bears hardship without complaint and a Samaritan helps people in need.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Expensively

Shoes priced 'extravagantly' are priced far too high, that is 'expensively'. 'Modestly', 'economically' and 'meagerly' point the other way.

Q.16 · Answer (A) never

'It's never too late' to do something means it can still be done.

Q.17 · Answer (A) to

'Impossible' is followed by the to-infinitive: 'impossible to guess'.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Indistinct

'Evident' means plain to see; 'indistinct', not clear, is its opposite. 'Obvious' is a synonym.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Anarchist
An anarchist believes in or works for a state without government or law. 'Ephemeral' means short-lived, a 'deluge' is a flood and a 'gazette' an official journal.

Q.20 · Answer (A) tragic
A sudden death is 'tragic', causing great sorrow; 'fragile', 'gentle' and 'dissuasive' do not fit the sense.

Q.21 · Answer (C) on
Life 'on' Earth: 'on' is used for the surface of a planet.

Q.22 · Answer (D) found
After 'can be' the passive needs the past participle: 'it can be found in all living systems'.

Q.23 · Answer (D) present
Nitrogen compounds are 'present' in, that is found in, organic materials, foods, fertilisers and the rest.

Q.24 · Answer (C) but
'But' introduces the contrast: nitrogen is crucial to life, but in excess it can also do harm.

Q.25 · Answer (A) harmful
In excess nitrogen can be 'harmful' to the environment, the contrast with 'crucial to life'.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (D) 336
The second number is the cube of the first minus the first: $2^3 - 2 = 6$ and $4^3 - 4 = 60$. So $7^3 - 7 = 343 - 7 = 336$.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Qimat
Facing the centre, a person's left is the next seat clockwise. Clockwise the girls sit Vineeta, Pooja, Shweta, Qimat (fourth to the right of Pooja), Reeti and Tejaswini, who is between Reeti and Vineeta. The next seat clockwise from Shweta is Qimat's.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Krishna
Farhan sits at an end of the top row with Utkarsh to his immediate right, so Farhan is at its left end. Manish, diagonally opposite, is at the right end of the bottom row and Krishna, second to his left, at its left end. Yugal is not in Krishna's row, so the top row is Farhan, Utkarsh and Yugal, Chaman sits between Krishna and Manish, and the end diagonally opposite Yugal is Krishna's.

Q.7 · Answer (A) + and –
After interchanging + and –: $133 - 49 + 16 \div 2 \times 34 = 133 - 49 + 272 = 356$.

Q.8 · Answer (A) KQR
The letters move +3, +2 and +2: P → S, A → C, N → P. Likewise H → K, O → Q, P → R: KQR.

Q.9 · Answer (A) DAA
The first and second letters move 3 forward and the third 3 back: R, U, X, A, D; O, R, U, X, A; M, J, G, D, A. The next cluster is DAA.

Q.10 · Answer (C) OSOL
Each pair of letters is swapped: TR EE → RT EE and KE EP → EK PE. So SO LO → OS OL: OSOL.

Q.11 · Answer (D) (6, 14, 84)
The third number is the product of the first two: $3 \times 6 = 18$ and $5 \times 7 = 35$. Likewise $6 \times 14 = 84$; the other sets would need 104, 84 and 96.

Q.12 · Answer (D) # qm
'West' is in the first two sentences, so it is 4; 'east' is in the last two, so it is #. 'Direction' is then 'jt' or 'qm', so 'direction east' can be '# qm', the only option with #.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Only conclusion II follows.
The pets that are birds are mats, so some mats are pets (II). The mats need not all be birds, so I does not follow.

Q.17 · Answer (B) UQBF
The letters move +1, +2, +1, +2: IFSP → JHTR and MPWF → NRXH. So TOAD → UQBF.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Only conclusion I follows
Some plates are forks and all forks are knives, so some plates are certainly knives, and what is certain is also possible: I follows. The forks that are plates are not spoons, but other forks may be, so II does not follow.

Q.19 · Answer (B) X 22
The letter and the number both move 4 forward: D → H and 2 → 6, L → P and 11 → 15. So T → X and 18 → 22: X 22.

Q.20 · Answer (C) + and ÷
After interchanging + and ÷: 9 ÷ 3 − 4 + 5 × 2 = 3 − 4 + 10 = 9.

Q.21 · Answer (C) 563
The differences are −11, −22, −33 and −44, so the next is −55: 618 − 55 = 563.

Q.22 · Answer (C) EUHEOIA
Each consonant moves one letter forward and each vowel stays (Y counts as a consonant: LIVELY → MIWEMZ). So E U G E N I A → E U H E O I A: EUHEOIA.

Q.23 · Answer (A) 51
The code is the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet plus 3: P + O + R = 16 + 15 + 18 = 49 and 49 + 3 = 52; A + N + D = 1 + 14 + 4 = 19 and 19 + 3 = 22. So V + X + B = 22 + 24 + 2 = 48 and 48 + 3 = 51.

Q.24 · Answer (B) 64
The second number is twice the first minus 4: 12 × 2 − 4 = 20 and 8 × 2 − 4 = 12. So 34 × 2 − 4 = 64.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Bharatanatyam
T. Balasaraswati (1918-1984) of the hereditary Thanjavur tradition was among the greatest Bharatanatyam dancers. Bihu is a folk dance of Assam, and Manipuri and Odissi are other classical forms.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Avani Lekhara
The International Paralympic Committee's 2021 Paralympic Sport Awards named the Indian shooter Avani Lekhara the best female debut, for her Tokyo 2020 gold in the women's 10 m air rifle standing SH1 and bronze in the 50 m rifle three positions SH1.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Luni
NCERT calls the Luni the largest river system of Rajasthan, west of the Aravallis; it rises near Pushkar and ends in the Rann of Kutch. The Krishna, Narmada and Tapi do not flow through Rajasthan.

Q.4 · Answer (D) 7 to 7.5
NCERT's Class 7 science text describes the small intestine as highly coiled and about 7.5 m long; it is the longest part of the alimentary canal.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Bhavani Devi
C A Bhavani Devi, a sabre fencer from Tamil Nadu, was the first Indian to compete in fencing at the Olympics, at Tokyo 2020. Aditi Ashok is a golfer, P T Usha a sprinter and P V Sindhu a badminton player.

Q.6 · Answer (A) microfinance
Microfinance gives small loans (microcredit), savings and insurance to poor and low-income households that ordinary banks do not reach; in India it works largely through self-help groups and microfinance institutions.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Bryophytes
Bryophytes (mosses and liverworts) live on land but need water for fertilisation, as their sperm swim to the egg, so they are called the amphibians of the plant kingdom.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Bodh Gaya
Siddhartha Gautama attained enlightenment under the Bodhi tree at Bodh Gaya in Bihar. He gave his first sermon at Sarnath near Varanasi and died at Kusinara (Kushinagar).

Q.9 · Answer (A) Priyanka Chopra Jonas
'Unfinished: A Memoir' (2021) is the actor Priyanka Chopra Jonas's memoir.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Magh Bihu
Magh (Bhogali) Bihu, in mid-January, marks the end of the harvest season in Assam with community feasts. Lohri is Punjab's festival, Pongal Tamil Nadu's, and Makaravilakku is held at Sabarimala in Kerala.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Bose-Einstein condensate
A Bose-Einstein condensate, formed when a gas of bosons is cooled almost to absolute zero so that the particles fall into the same lowest state, is called the fifth state of matter, after solid, liquid, gas and plasma.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Godavari
The Godavari, the longest peninsular river (the 'Dakshin Ganga'), also has the largest drainage basin among the peninsular rivers.

Q.13 · Answer (D) seasonal unemployment
Seasonal unemployment comes when farm work is available only at sowing and harvest, leaving people without work for part of the year. Disguised unemployment is more people working on a farm than it needs.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 1498
Vasco da Gama reached Calicut (Kozhikode) on the Malabar coast in May 1498, opening the sea route from Europe to India round the Cape of Good Hope.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Badruddin Tyabji
Badruddin Tyabji presided over the third session of the Congress, at Madras in 1887, its first Muslim president. W C Bonnerjee presided over the first session (Bombay, 1885) and Dadabhai Naoroji over the second (Calcutta, 1886).

Q.16 · Answer (B) Patna Pirates
Dabang Delhi KC beat Patna Pirates 37-36 in the final of season 8 of the Pro Kabaddi League, in February 2022, for their first title.

Q.17 · Answer (A) hydroponics
Hydroponics is growing plants without soil, with their roots in water carrying dissolved mineral nutrients.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Article 23
Articles 23 and 24 form the Right against Exploitation: Article 23 prohibits traffic in human beings and forced labour, and Article 24 the employment of children in factories, mines and other hazardous work. Article 21 protects life and personal liberty, Article 22 guards against arbitrary arrest and Article 25 gives freedom of religion.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Prayer hall
A chaitya is a Buddhist prayer hall, usually with a stupa at its far end, as in the rock-cut halls at Karla and Ajanta; a vihara is a monastery where monks lived.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 2.1 - 2.9
SSC's key gives 2.1-2.9: the Sample Registration System put India's total fertility rate at 2.4 children per woman in 2011, the census year.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Anoushka Shankar
Anoushka Shankar, daughter and pupil of Pandit Ravi Shankar, is a sitar player. Pandit Kishan Maharaj was a tabla player and Ustad Ali Ahmad Hussain Khan a shehnai player.

Q.22 · Answer (D) five years
Under Article 56 the President holds office for a term of five years from the date on which he enters upon his office.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Kerala
Mohiniyattam, a graceful solo dance in the lasya style, is a classical dance of Kerala.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Rajaraja I
The Brihadeshwara (Rajarajeshwaram) temple at Thanjavur was built by the Chola king Rajaraja I and completed around 1010 CE.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Odisha
In 2021 Odisha decided to set up District Investment Promotion Agencies (DIPAs), chaired by the district collectors and working as district arms of IPICOL, the state's investment promotion agency.

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